

The Gazette Looking back

100 years ago — Jan 8, 1886

A peeler — Frost nipped extremities are fashionable this morning. We have not heard of anyone who is anxious to be in the fashion, however. The thermometer registered 14° below zero this morning, and with old Boreas putting in some solid work the weather is simply brutal.

A cowardly act — An eleven-year-old son of Mr TW McDermott was driving home after being out a few miles in Ramsay on Tuesday last, and on the way turned out to let a team and three men in a sleigh pass. While passing, one of the trio, who were probably under the influence of liquor, struck the McDermott horse over the head with the butt of the whip causing it to run away. The youthful driver pluckily held on to the reins till he reached the hill at Mr E Coon's, where he was thrown out and had his back slightly injured. The horse kept up its runaway gait till it arrived at Mr McD's house, several persons narrowly missing contact with it on the way. The cutter was injured to some extent. We understand that Mr McDermott is making an effort to ascertain the names of the parties, and if he is successful promises to make it hot for the cowardly fellow who was the cause of the runaway. May he succeed.

50 years ago — Jan 9, 1936

Canadian Pacific Railway retires former Almonter — The mournful wail of the locomotive whistle is a thing of the past so far as one of our old Almonte boys is concerned. Wm Edmonds, for 38 years in the service of the CPR as a locomotive engineer has been retired.

He is visiting relatives in Almonte after long service in the west. He is hale, hearty and jovial and looks for a long time ahead to discuss with friends his years on the prairies.

Discipline — Because the quintuplets break windows and dishes in their hospital, Dr Daffoe is having unbreakable glass to replace the regular variety. There's what it is to be a quintuplet. If they were ordinary babies they'd probably get a sound spanking which would solve the problem much more simply.

25 years ago — Jan 5, 1961

The better 'ole — Did anybody ever see a fur-bearing animal like this one? A muskrat usually builds its house on a creek or in a marsh with plenty to eat and drink. But to our surprise one came to the home of Alec Bowes on Dec 18th. A few days later, it was found well established in a shallow pan, under a box stove partly enclosed by tin, to control the heat in his garage.

Menace of Rabies looms on farms in Huntley Twp — Rabies has broken out again, this time in Huntley Township. A ten months' old steer owned by John S Brown fell sick over the weekend and Dr AA Hanna, Almonte Veterinarian was called. The animal showed almost unmistakable signs of rabies.

As Mr Brown had been attempting home treatment on his steer, he is now receiving preventative treatment under Dr John King of Almonte as a precautionary measure.

10 years ago — Jan 8, 1976

Dr Casey elected chairman of new industrial commission — Dr Jerry Casey of Almonte, a scientist with the Defence Research Board, was elected chairman of the recently re-activated Almonte Industrial Commission at the inaugural meeting of the organization held in December.

Mr Mervin Tosh was elected as secretary. Other members of the commission include council members Harold Swierenga and Ron Pettem, Alan Sheffield and John Cochran.

Don Buchan hired as arena manager — Mr Don Buchan of RR 3, Almonte, officially took over his duties Monday as the new arena manager at the Almonte Community Centre complex.

Recently retired followed 35 years service in the Canadian Armed Forces, Don has been deeply involved in local minor hockey organizations during the past several years as president of the Almonte Minor Hockey Association and Almonte representative on the Ottawa District Minor Hockey Association for two years as well as registrar and statistician for two years.

Wit and Wisdom

By George Lowry

Hello folks:
Life is mostly froth and bubble;
Two things stand like stone —
Kindness in another's trouble
Courage in your own.

Professor Moss: "What books do you find have benefited you most?"
Freshman: "Ma's cookbook, and Dad's bank book."

Judge: "What made you think you could park your car there?"
Townsmen: "Well, there was a big sign on the pole that read — 'Fine For Parking.'"

It is easy enough to be happy
When life is a bright rosy wreath
But the man worthwhile
Is the man who can smile
When the dentist is filling his tooth.

Bert: "If I had a million dollars, do you know where I'd be now?"
Myrt: "I sure do — you'd be on our honeymoon."

The guest speaker of the evening had given a long talk and as he thumped the desk in conclusion he said, "I want land reform. I want housing reform. I want educational reform — I want . . ."

Just as a bored voice in the audience interrupted, "What you need most is chloroform."

Neighbor: "Orinidge, now that you are 100 years old, do you regret anything?"
Grandson: "No, but if I'd known, I was going to live this long. I'd of took more care of myself."

Columns

page 5



Pic of the Past

Here's a lovely old photo taken in Almonte in 1901, and shows four generations from great grandmother to great grandson. At far left is Mrs M Anderson, great grandmother. Mrs Robert Cameron, grandmother, Master Alexander Chisholm, son and Mrs Roderick Chisholm

(nee Cameron), mother. Our thanks to Shirley McGee, granddaughter of Mrs Roderick Chisholm, of North York, Ontario for use of this week's Pic.

Record sightings in Almonte for bird count

I believe a leaf of grass is no less than the journey-work of the stars.

— Walt Whitman — 1886 —

Here in Almonte, 1985 gave us some very interesting and often unusual bird sightings: A tundra swan, red-headed woodpeckers, and a northern phalarope to mention just a few, and the winter is proving a good one as we step into a new year.

Predators were very much in the news, both in Ottawa and in our own area where an increase in the number of well stocked feeders attracted not only more smaller birds but also hungry hawks, and may have accounted for some birders reporting no birds or very few on the day of the bird count.

Gill and Libby Goddard of Mitcheson Street had an injured northern shrike who went on his way when he recovered. Often called the "butcher bird," he has another accomplishment which often goes unnoticed, for even when the snow is still on the ground he is a lusty singer.

The morning after the bird count we were enjoying an unusually large number of small birds feeding on the

The Nature Beat

By J Norma Taylor



S.J.T.

BOHEMIAN
WAXWING

ground beneath a feeder full of mixed wild bird seed hanging from the locust tree. Suddenly, the small birds vanished into the cedar hedge and swift as a "dart," a male goshawk landed in the tree above, 20 feet from the window, where it remained for about five minutes, giving us a detailed back and side view before plunging into a hole in the hedge. We were concerned, as there is a chainlink fence on the far side of the hedge, and we watched intently till he emerged quite some minutes later very dishevelled, to perch again on the branch. This time he was facing us, and we were able to study this majestic hawk as he preened himself.

The goshawk is a heavy bodied hawk, 20 to 26 inches, dark blue-grey back, black crown, pale underparts finely barred and a conspicuous white eyebrow. He stayed for about 20 minutes as if to pull himself together, but the other birds didn't reappear till next day.

Maynard McIntosh of Wilson Street is enjoying the shy mourning doves who are visiting his feeder. Peggy Cameron also enjoys these birds and has a pileated woodpecker in the trees near the house. VI Larose of Spring

Street was visited by a lone robin and Helen Smith spotted an unusually large flock of about 40 goldfinches. Louis Wrigglesworth who has a feeder at the front of his house, much to the delight of the passing schoolchildren, had five pine grosbeaks. They have also been seen at Fairview and around the hospital, the lone robin has been spotted at this feeder too.

The annual Almonte/Carleton Place bird count was most interesting with a total of 41 species reported in all, and 5,532 birds. Almonte had 29 different species — a record, and the 27 feeder reports from Almonte were a terrific help. Cardinals were the stars of the day, 17 were seen in all, eight of which were in Almonte, showing that they are increasing. A kestrel, a cooper's hawk, a raven and one red tailed hawk as well as a song sparrow and 198 Bohemian waxwings were also among the Almonte highlights.

Thank you so much to all who participated and to Arnie Simpson of Appleton who organized this event. Please continue to report your sightings and interesting experiences. My number is 256-2741.

Celebrations fun, plentiful during New Year's

As I tried to remember to date my cheques with 1986 during the past week, I found it difficult to believe that 1985 was over.

Where did the last 365 days go? It doesn't seem so awfully long ago that I was adjusting to writing 1985 instead of 1984.

There is evidence of both looking backwards and forwards as the new year unfolds.

The media is full of year-end reviews summarizing outstanding events of the past 12 months. (Besides what else is there to report about during the full of Christmas holidays?)

At the same time many people look towards the next year with much anticipation. Some even go so far as to set themselves ambitious goals, known as resolutions. They resolve to lose weight, work harder, drink less and many other admirable objectives with a whole year to carry out these tasks ahead of them.

The end of the year, although technically a night like any other preceding or following it, certainly doesn't pass without notice. It's impossible to judge whether New Year's Eve merrymakers are heralding the next year or saluting the last one during Dec 31 celebrations.

The customs vary around the globe. Many tactics for marking the stroke of midnight, including shooting guns and blowing car horns, require noise and lots of it.

Others such as opening doors and windows to allow the new year in and the old year out, are quieter.

A Canadian New Year's Eve tradition seems to have started on Parliament Hill in Ottawa this year. As outdoor celebration complete with music,



Rosemary
MacVicar

dancing and fireworks drew more people than expected. Who needs Times Square in New York, said the critics, when Canadians have the Peace Tower clock to use for a countdown.

I didn't make it to the Hill, but I was in the city and saw the masses converge on the streets following the celebrations. It was about 12:30 am, as the crowds streamed through dark, frosty downtown Ottawa. This in the city where the streets are said to be rolled up at midnight.

Many of the Hill partiers were bound for the "last bus" run of the evening as I was. This ride provided one of the more entertaining highlights of the evening.

Everyone was in a friendly mood as they boarded. A handful of middle-aged women dressed in warm clothing, but passengers a robust, if slightly "upstirred" Happy New Year as they found seats.

By the time the bus left Rideau Street it was full to capacity with merrymakers of all descriptions. The vehicle was so full of riders taking advantage of the free New Year's Eve service, that the people standing, and they were packed in tighter than sardines in a can, overflowed onto sitting passengers with elbows and knees.

The bus driver saw his work cut out for him navigating the road and making stops. Energetic teenagers leaned out open bus windows shouting farewells and waving to departing passengers. They also tried to discourage additional riders by yelling when the bus pulled up to another stop.

One young guy, who was maybe 15 or 16-years-old looked like he was going to fall over at any minute. It soon became apparent that his buddies feared he would be as sick as he looked. Fortunately he didn't have to stand for too long, but chances are good, it was a night he won't forget for a while.

At one point when the bus driver had to leave the vehicle, some of the teenagers decided to expand their poster collections by tearing down advertisements from above the seats. Their urge, however, wasn't too strong. When an adult male rider told them not to take down any of the free bus ride, they quickly ended these antics. Some of them even looked embarrassed.

No doubt the bus driver was relieved as he delivered his last passenger that night. Although, with that crew, it wouldn't be surprising if someone missed, forgot or slept through their stop.

There were countless private and public celebrations to salute the new

year locally including the annual Almonte Legion Levee.

Fairview Manor residents celebrated New Year's Eve this past Saturday, Jan 4. The occasion was no less festive than if it had been at the stroke of midnight Jan 1, 1986.

Everyone gathered in the Manor diningroom looked delighted with a cascade of colored balloons which was let loose from the ceiling during the evening. Young, old and middle-aged batted them around for a good 10 minutes or so before joining hands to sing "Auld Lang Syne."

My short visit to the Manor to photograph some of these festivities certainly was proof to me that age is just a state of mind.

The child in people, which emerges readily at times like New Year's Eve, is a valuable part of everyone at all stages of life.

The next year will be a most successful and happy one if the celebrations to welcome it were any indication. Happy 1986!

Express your opinion
in writing
to the editor
at Box 130,
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